I also raised the issue of Afghanistan and the Soviet support of Qaddafi.

> It is hard to reconcile Soviet interest in restraint in this region with the provision of advanced weapons to a leader whose reckless behavior is a major danger to regional stability. Because we view this development with utmost seriousness, I was disappointed to see that the Soviet response to our presentation failed to address the transfer of [recently shipped advance] weapons to Libya. Our ministers and experts should address this vital matter, since it raises the prospect of dangerous incidents that I hope you want to avoid as much as we do. If you agree, both Angola and Libya are additional subjects which Secretary Shultz and Foreign Minister Shevardnadze might take up in their next meeting.

In a Christmas Eve reply to my letter dated November 28, Gorbachev said that he appreciated its personal and handwritten nature and that he was pleased that at Geneva we had managed to

> overcome a serious psychological barrier which for a long time has hindered a dialogue worthy of the leaders of the USSR and the USA.
>
> I also have the feeling now that we can set aside our differences and get down to the heart of the matter—we can set a specific agenda for discussing in the upcoming years how to straighten out Soviet-American relations. . . . I agree with you, Mr. President: In the final analysis, no one besides us can do this.

Then, he launched into an explanation of his country's opposition to "space-strike weapons"—the Strategic Defense Initiative—that I thought was seriously flawed.